

White Rhino

Ceratotherium simum

Near Threatened

Fact Sheet · Colouring Page · Activities

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White Rhino — Fact Sheet

Scientific name	Ceratotherium simum
Conservation status	Near Threatened
Region	South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe, Kenya, Uganda
Habitat	Grasslands, savannas, and bushveld of southern and east Africa
Diet	Herbivore (grazer) — grass almost exclusively; up to 50 kg of grass per day
Weight	1,500–2,300 kg
Size	1.5–1.85 m at shoulder
Lifespan	40–50 years in the wild
Wild population	Around 17,000–20,000 (Southern subspecies); only 2 females remain of Northern subspecies

Did You Know?

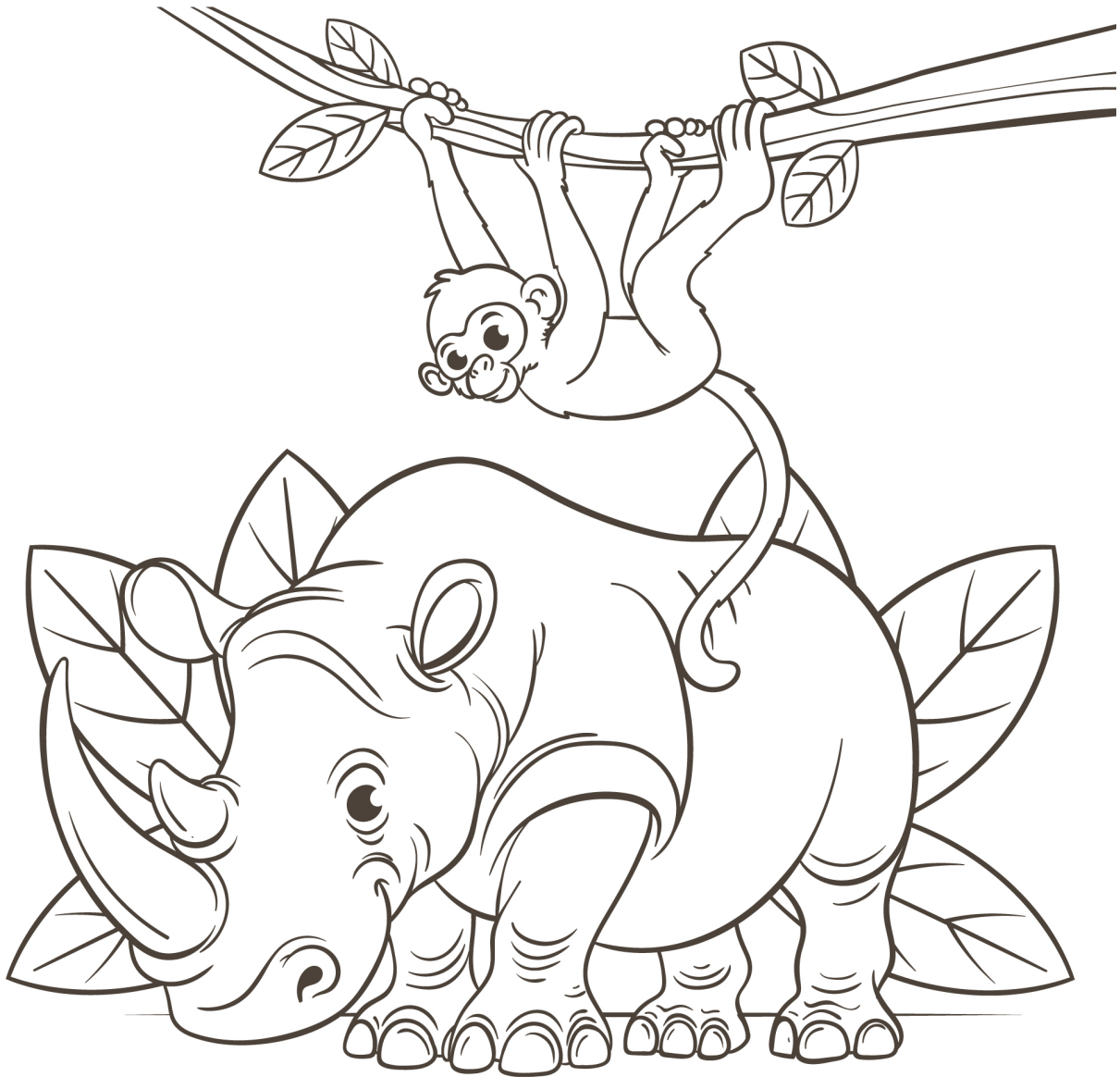
- Despite the name, white rhinos are not white — 'white' comes from the Afrikaans word 'wyd' (wide), describing their wide square lip for grazing.
- Rhino horn is made of keratin — the exact same protein as your fingernails — not bone or ivory.
- A group of rhinos is called a 'crash'!
- Rhinos have poor eyesight but an extraordinary sense of smell — they can detect water from kilometres away.
- The Southern White Rhino is one of conservation's greatest success stories — saved from just 50 animals in 1895 to 20,000 today!
- Oxpecker birds hitch rides on rhinos, eating ticks and parasites — a perfect partnership for both animals.

Threats to Survival

1. Poaching for horn — worth more by weight than gold on illegal black markets
2. Habitat loss from agriculture and human settlement expansion
3. Northern White Rhino effectively extinct — only 2 females remain on Earth
4. Political instability in range countries limiting anti-poaching efforts

Colour Me: White Rhino

White rhinos are actually grey with very thick, deeply wrinkled skin. Their wide square lip and two horns (front horn larger) are distinctive.



White Rhino — Activities

Word Search

Find all 8 words hidden in the grid.

T	P	Y	H	U	L	O	Z	Z	O	O	Q
P	D	O	O	V	N	A	M	D	L	D	F
E	K	N	A	I	G	C	F	F	H	K	C
N	G	V	H	C	V	F	U	R	X	A	S
B	S	R	N	S	H	C	N	Z	I	B	A
S	F	U	J	I	O	I	X	J	S	C	V
C	H	Z	F	K	T	G	N	B	A	G	A
M	V	O	J	A	I	W	L	G	G	R	N
C	F	K	R	K	C	R	A	S	H	Y	N
Q	N	E	K	N	R	T	X	Q	U	E	A
Q	K	M	K	C	W	G	R	A	Z	E	R
I	L	C	F	Q	L	B	K	U	S	H	X

RHINO	HORN	SAVANNA	POACHING
AFRICA	GRAZER	KERATIN	CRASH

Match It Up

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

White Rhino		made of keratin, like fingernails
Horn		a group of rhinos
Crash		a bird that eats ticks off rhinos
Poaching		illegal hunting for the horn
Oxpecker		grazer with a wide square lip

Fill in the Blanks

1. Rhino horn is made of _____, the same as fingernails.
2. A group of rhinos is called a _____.
3. White rhinos are _____ — they eat mostly grass.
4. There are only _____ Northern White Rhinos left.

Answers: keratin / crash / grazers / 2

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